SANDVIKEN INDIAN COMMUNITY

STATUTES

Article 1: Name and Legal Form

The association shall be called **Sandviken Indian Community (SIC)**, hereinafter referred to as "the Association." It is established as a **non-profit, cultural organization** under the laws of **Sweden**.

Article 2: Registered Office

The official registered address of the Association shall be **Sandviken, Sweden**. The Board of Directors may change the registered office as necessary.

Article 3: Purpose and Objectives

To promote Indian culture and heritage through cultural activities, festivals, and educational events that are open to everyone. The association aims to foster an inclusive community for people of Indian origin and others interested in Indian traditions, support cultural exchange with Swedish society, and provide social and cultural support to its members — all within a democratic, non-profit, and non-political framework. As well encouraging community bonding through sports, social activities, and volunteering.

Article 4: Duration

The Association is established for an indefinite period unless dissolved as per the provisions applicable law.

Membership

Article 5: Membership Categories

1.1 Membership Eligibility

Membership is open to any individual who supports the purpose and values of the association and agrees to comply with its statutes and decisions.

1.2 Application Process

Individuals wishing to join must submit a completed membership form and pay the applicable membership fee (if any).
The board reviews and approves membership applications. In special cases, the board reserves the right to reject applications that are not in alignment with the association's objectives.

1.3 Membership Rights and Obligations

Members have the right to:

- Participate in events and activities organized by the association
- Attend and vote at general meetings
- Contest in association election process as per defined rules
- Propose ideas and raise matters for discussion

Members are obligated to:

- Uphold the association's purpose
- Follow its statutes and decisions
- Pay any membership fees on time

1.4 Termination of Membership

Membership may end through:

- **Voluntary withdrawal** by written notice
- **Non-payment** of membership fees after two reminders
- **Exclusion**, if the member violates the statutes or in any way violates the association's purpose and Code of conducts.

1.5 Exclusion Process

Exclusion is decided by the board, which must notify the member in writing, stating the reasons clearly. The excluded member has the right to appeal the decision to the next general meeting, where a final decision will be made.

Membership Fees

- **Purpose**: Membership fees help cover the association's operational costs, such as event organization, communication, administration, workshops and other activities that support its purpose and objectives.
- The membership fee is set by the General Meeting and may be revised annually.
- Members must pay the fee to maintain active status and memberrights.
- Fees are generally non-refundable.
- Different fee levels (e.g., students and pensioners) may be introduced to promote inclusivity.

Governance and Administration

Article 9: General Assembly

The General Assembly is the highest governing body of the Association. It consists of all members and convenes at least **once a year**.

Article 10: Powers of the General Assembly

The General Assembly shall:

- Approve amendments to the statutes.
- Elect the Board of Directors.
- Approve financial reports and budgets.
- Decide on dissolution, if necessary.

Article 11: Board of Directors

The Association is managed by a Board of Directors composed of at least **five (5) elected members**, including:

- **President**
- **General Secretary**
- **Communication Secretary -**
- **Treasurer -**
- **Cultural Secretary**
- **Compliance Secretary**

Executive Committee —

Based on the event and situation need Board will propose a executive committee extension to Board

The Board members shall serve a term of **[2 years]**, with re-election permitted.

Article 12: Responsibilities of the Board

The Board is responsible for:

- Planning and organizing community events.
- Managing finances and administrative duties.
- Representing the Association in public and legal matters.

Article 13: Meetings of the Board and Members

1. Types of Meetings

a. **General Meetings –** Open to all members, held quarterly.
b. **Board Meetings –** Attended by board members and on need meeting executive committee held regularly (e.g., monthly or as needed).
c. **Special Meetings –** Called for urgent matters requiring immediate attention.

2. Notice for Meetings

a. Notice must be sent via email, mail, or other agreed-upon communication channels.
b. **General Meetings –** At least **30 days notice** should be provided.
c. **Board Meetings –** At least **7 days notice** should be given.
d. **Special Meetings –** Minimum **3 days notice** unless it is an emergency.

3. Calling a Meeting

a. General meetings are scheduled by the Board of Directors.
b. Special meetings may be called by the President, a majority of the Board, or a percentage of members (10%) submitting a written request.
c. Meeting agendas should be shared in advance with members.

4. Quorum Requirements

a. **General Meetings –** At least **20 % of active members** to be present to convene the meeting, otherwise the meeting will be postponed for future.Next general meeting date will be decided byboard of directors.

b. **Board Meetings –** At least **half of board members plus one**.
If quorum is not met, the meeting may be rescheduled within a month's period.

5. Decision-Making & Voting

a. Decisions are made by majority vote by attending members unless otherwise stated in the bylaws.
b. Voting may be done by show of hands, ballot, or digitally as the board decides.
c. Tie-breaking votes are decided by the President or a designated officer appointed by the board..

6. Meeting Minutes & Records

a. Minutes must be recorded for all official meetings and approved at the next meeting.
b. A designated officer (e.g., Secretary) ensures proper record-keeping.
c. Members have the right to access meeting minutes upon request.

7. General meeting agenda

The agenda for the meeting will be reviewed and adopted, allowing members to suggest any urgent additions. Minutes from the previous General Body Meeting will be presented for approval, ensuring that all members are aligned with past discussions and resolutions.

The board will present updates on the organization's overall performance, including a summary of key activities, milestones, and challenges. The Treasurer will provide a comprehensive financial review, covering income, expenses, fundraising efforts, and budget allocations. Committee representatives will share updates on their respective areas, outlining recent initiatives and upcoming plans. Financial audits, regulatory compliance, and membership fees (if applicable) will also be discussed to ensure financial transparency and sustainability.

Members will deliberate on key association matters, including proposed amendments to bylaws or policies, elections or appointments of office bearers, and planning for future events and initiatives. Urgent or special issues requiring immediate action will also be addressed, along with new proposals from members regarding collaborations, advocacy efforts, or program expansions. Where necessary, voting will be conducted to finalize decisions democratically.

General meeting being open forum will allow members to share their feedback, raise concerns, and contribute ideas for the association’s growth. Board will provide responses and clarify any uncertainties. The meeting will conclude with a summary of key decisions.

Financial Management

Article 14: Funding and Resources

The Association is funded by:

- Membership fees (if applicable).
- Voluntary donations and sponsorships.
- Grants from cultural and governmental institutions.
- Fundraising events.

Article 15: Financial Year and Auditing

The financial year runs from **January 1st to December 31st**.(except for the first year of incorporation) The Treasurer shall present an annual financial report to the General Assembly for approval.

Amendments and Dissolution

Article 16: Amendment of Statutes

Amendments to the statutes require approval by **two-thirds (2/3) majority** vote of the General Assembly by the members present at the meeting

Article 17: Dissolution of the Association

In the event of dissolution, the General Assembly shall decide on the allocation of remaining assets, ensuring they are used for cultural or charitable purposes aligned with the Association's mission and aligned with local rules and regulations

Article 18: Final Provisions

Any matters not covered by these statutes shall be governed by **local non-profit organization laws**

Questions :

1. **Address – Do we need to have address or only Post box is ok ?**
2. **Code of conduct need to be write.**
3. **Revisit the Fee area**
4. **By laws**
5. **Clarification from Community on auditing**
6. **Membership registration benefit**